TENACIO

Beyond KYC: Scaling High-Margin Enterprise Revenue in BFSI

A data-backed case for Tenacio's market positioning, built on TrustMRR's public database of verified startup revenue.

138	$1.51B	Aug 2026
SECURITY STARTUPS ANALYZED	REVENUE TRACKED ON TRUSTMRR	DATA SNAPSHOT DATE

Pranil Palan, Founder & CEO — Tenacio

Where this data comes from — and why it matters

Every figure in the next slide is pulled directly from TrustMRR.com, not estimated — here's what that source is and how we used it.

01	What TrustMRR is	A public database of startup revenue verified directly through payment processors like Stripe, RevenueCat and LemonSqueezy — not self-reported screenshots. It tracks $1.51B+ in revenue across 53M transactions (snapshot: August 2026).
02	Why we used it	It's one of the few places you can compare real Monthly Recurring Revenue — MRR, the predictable income a subscription business earns each month — across different types of software, broken down by category.
03	What we pulled	TrustMRR's Security category (cybersecurity, privacy & identity companies), its Developer Tools/API and Fintech categories, and its own platform-wide "Most Profitable Categories" ranking.

Caveat: startups list themselves voluntarily, so the sample skews toward indie and bootstrapped founders — it isn't a census of the software industry. Because every number is payment-provider verified, though, the pattern is directionally reliable.

Source: trustmrr.com

DATA FINDING

Security & compliance software earns more — with far less competition

TrustMRR ranks every category on the platform by total revenue. Here's how the categories relevant to Tenacio compare.

	Startups tracked	
SECURITY	138 startups tracked	Ranked #2 of all categories on TrustMRR by total platform revenue
DEVELOPER TOOLS / API	1,187 startups tracked	The single largest category on the platform — does not place in the top 10 most profitable categories
FINTECH	375 startups tracked	Also outside the top 10 most profitable categories

The proof point: 1Lookup — a real-time phone, email & IP verification API — earns $224,419/month, the 6th-highest revenue of any startup tracked on all of TrustMRR, across every category. Comp AI, a SOC 2/ISO 27001 compliance automation tool, has driven $4.4M in lifetime tracked revenue.

What it means: a generic "verification API" or "fintech tool" label competes in the platform's most crowded categories. A "security & compliance" label competes in one of its most profitable — with 8x fewer rivals.

Source: trustmrr.com/stats, trustmrr.com/category/security, /developer-tools, /fintech (Aug 2026)

THE PROBLEM

What this means for Indian banks and lenders

Financial institutions face high customer drop-off, fragmented vendors, and a compliance deadline most haven't started preparing for.

Vendor Fragmentation	Banks juggle 10+ separate identity-verification vendors (PAN, CERSAI, bank-account checks) just to run one KYC — "Know Your Customer" — check. That drives up cost and failure rates.	TENACIO ANSWER **Single API Orchestration** CONNECT
New-to-Credit Blindspot	400M+ Indians have no credit bureau history, so lenders either reject them outright or take on hidden default risk.	TENACIO ANSWER **Alternate Data Scoring** SENSE
The DPDP Deadline	India's Digital Personal Data Protection Act (DPDP) 2023 requires proper consent and data-handling by May 14, 2027, with penalties reported up to ₹250 crore for non-compliance.	TENACIO ANSWER **Zero-Data-Egress Governance** SHIELD

How Tenacio answers each gap

Three connected products — one single integration. Connect brings the data in, Sense turns it into a decision, Shield keeps it compliant.

SENSE

Customer Intelligence

Turns minimal inputs into a live customer profile — identity, value, intent and fraud propensity.

- ✓ Genuine identity confidence
- ✓ Purchase & investment propensity
- ✓ Fraud propensity & behavioural signals

CONNECT

Onboarding Infrastructure

Orchestrates KYC, KYB, banking, employment, and fraud APIs through one single integration.

- ✓ KYC onboarding stack
- ✓ Bank verification & penny drop
- ✓ AI vendor routing & failover

SHIELD

DPDP Compliance & Privacy

Consent management, data governance, and audit trails — in a zero-data-egress architecture.

- ✓ Tamper-proof consent (SHA-256)
- ✓ Data Points Registry & RoPA
- ✓ Zero data egress — on-premise

The DPDP “Trojan Horse” strategy

A compliance deadline solves the problem that normally stalls enterprise sales: nobody wants to switch a working vendor.

THE SALES BOTTLENECK

CTOs delay replacing a working KYC vendor because switching APIs carries real operational effort.

THE COMPLIANCE CATALYST

The DPDP deadline creates urgent, non-negotiable demand from CFOs, General Counsels, and DPOs to avoid penalties.

THE EXECUTION SEQUENCE

1 SHIELD

Land

Deploy DPDP compliance modules inside the bank’s own security perimeter — low-friction, urgent, budget already exists.

2 CONNECT

Expand

Once inside, migrate onboarding API traffic to Tenacio’s unified router with zero switching friction.

3 SENSE

Upsell

Activate alternate data scoring to boost approval rates and lower churn — the highest-margin layer.

BUSINESS MODEL

Hybrid pricing: frictionless volume + sticky retainers

Two revenue motions, working together — a low-friction entry point, and a high-ticket compliance retainer.

CONNECT

Usage-Based API Credits

MODEL

Micro-transaction fees per API verification lookup.

ADVANTAGE

Low entry barrier for clients; revenue scales dynamically with their onboarding volume — the same model that earns 1Lookup $224k/month on TrustMRR.

SHIELD · SENSE

Enterprise SaaS & On-Premise Retainers

MODEL

Flat monthly or annual fees based on active data modules and compliance auditing.

ADVANTAGE

High-ticket, predictable ARR secured through dedicated legal and security budgets — budgets that exist because of the DPDP deadline.

LONG-TERM MOAT

Why this gets harder to copy over time

As more institutions plug in, the same verification calls start protecting each other — turning a single API into a shared fraud shield.

Bank A Catch

Fraud signal detected during onboarding

→

Tenacio AI Fraud Engine

Cross-institution pattern matching in real time

→

Bank B Auto-Blocked

Same identity flagged before disbursement

Cross-Platform Protection

Fraudsters commonly reuse synthetic identity traits across multiple lenders at once (“loss stacking”).

Network Advantage

As more institutions use Tenacio, the AI identifies cross-institution fraud patterns in real time — before a loan is disbursed.

Platform Lock-In

Over time, this becomes a shared defense layer clients can’t easily replicate by switching to a single-point vendor.

This is the strategic bet the moat is built on — value compounds as adoption grows.

STRATEGIC SUMMARY

Why this positioning wins

Three reasons the data, the regulation, and the product all point the same direction.

1

Category Alignment

TrustMRR’s own data shows security & compliance software outranks generic API and fintech categories — with 8x less competition.

2

Regulatory Tailwinds

The DPDP Act 2023 deadline (May 14, 2027) turns a legal headache into Tenacio’s fastest, most urgent acquisition channel.

3

A Working Platform, Not a Pitch

Sense, Connect and Shield are live today — 50+ clients, 99.9% uptime, 98.4% onboarding success — delivering lower costs, higher approvals, and audit-ready compliance.

Sources: trustmrr.com, tenacio.io